

Topic 3: Claude by Anthropic

3.1 What Makes Claude Different?

- Claude is built by Anthropic, an AI safety company, with a strong focus on honesty and avoiding harmful outputs
- Industry-leading context window: Claude 3.5 supports up to 200,000 tokens (~150,000 words) in one conversation
- Free tier: Claude 3.5 Haiku (fast, capable); Claude.ai Pro (\$20/month): Claude 3.5 Sonnet and Opus
- Excellent at: processing long documents, nuanced writing, following complex multi-part instructions, and code review
- Try it: <https://claude.ai> | Developer docs: <https://www.anthropic.com/claude>

3.2 Claude's Key Strengths

- Long documents: upload entire books, legal contracts, codebases, or research papers and ask questions about them
- Writing quality: tends to produce more natural, less formulaic prose than many AI tools
- Instruction following: very reliable at adhering to detailed, multi-part instructions across a long response
- Code review: provides thorough, thoughtful feedback on code architecture and logic, not just syntax
- Analytical reasoning: handles nuanced, ambiguous problems where there is no single clear answer

3.3 Best Use Cases for Claude

- Contract and legal review: upload a long document and ask for a plain-English summary and risk flags
- Research synthesis: upload multiple papers and ask Claude to compare methodologies and synthesise findings
- Long-form writing: chapters, detailed reports, complex proposals -- Claude maintains coherence across long outputs
- Complex coding questions: paste an entire codebase context and ask architectural or debugging questions
- Sensitive topics: Claude handles nuanced or difficult discussions with care

Example -- contract review prompt:

'I am uploading a 30-page supplier agreement.

Please:

1. Summarise the key terms in plain English
(payment terms, IP ownership, termination clauses, liability caps)
2. Flag any clauses that are unusual or unfavourable to the buyer
3. List 3 questions I should ask before signing

Assume I am a non-lawyer small business owner.'

3.4 Claude vs ChatGPT -- Practical Guide

- Use Claude when: the input is very long, writing quality is critical, or you need precise instruction-following
 - Use ChatGPT when: you need image generation (DALL-E 3), spreadsheet analysis, web browsing, or Custom GPTs
 - Use both in parallel for important tasks: paste the same prompt into both and compare; they complement each other
 - Switching cost is zero: both run in the browser with no installation required
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